

# Great crested newt

*Triturus cristatus*

This is the largest newt species in northern Europe. In summer, great crested newts hunt on land by night. In winter, they hibernate in sheltered spots or at the bottom of their breeding pools. Males court by arching their bodies and wafting their paddle-shaped tails. Females lay their eggs on submerged plants, each egg wrapped in a leaf for protection. The larvae hatch after three weeks and transform into the air-breathing form after about four months.

- ↔ 4–6 in (10–14 cm)
- ☁ Spring
- ⊗ Common
- 🐛 Larvae, worms
- 🏠 🌿
- 📍 Europe, C. Asia

## ▽ BREEDING CREST

Females are larger than males, but only males grow a crest during the spring breeding season.

distinctive black markings



# Pale tussock

*Calliteara pudibunda*

heavily feathered antennae of male

crescent-shaped marking



This chunky moth is one of the most widespread moth species. It lives in the woodlands of Europe, where the adults (which do not feed) can be seen flying at night in late spring and early summer. Males use their antennae to sweep the air for the scent of mates. Eggs are laid on trees and hatch the following spring.

- ↔ 2–3 in (5–7 cm)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌳 Tree foliage
- 🏠 🌿 🌳
- 📍 Europe

## ▷ TUFTED CATERPILLAR

Some of the bristles are bunched into four distinct tufts.



- ↔ Average 1/2 in (12 mm)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐝 Pollen, nectar, honey
- 🏠 🌿 🌳



Europe, W., C., and SW. Asia, W., E., and S. Africa

## △ HARD AT WORK

During construction of a new honeycomb, honeybee workers use their bodies to form a bridge across the gap.

## ▷ PACKING POLLEN

A forager bee packs pollen into her pollen baskets—a hollow section of each hind leg caged in by bristles.

